GG-C-00439C(DSA-DM)
January 24, 1975
Interim Revision of
Fed. Spec. GG-C-439b
July 18, 1957

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CLIP, SUTURE, MICHEL, 16 mm

This Interim Federal specification was developed by the Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above. The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification GG-C-439b.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a metal suture clip, of the Michel design, suitable for use in suturing porcedures.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

GG-I-526	Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	Box, Wood, Cleated-plywood.
PPP-B-621	Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock-corner.
PPP-B-636	Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	Box, Set-up.

FSC 6515

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(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, DC).

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-P-116	Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	Liners, Case and Sheet, Overwrap; Watervaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.
MIL-F-36053	Forceps, Suture Clip, Applying and Removing, 11-18 mm.

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 22208	CLIP, SUTURE, MICHEL, 16 mm

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals shall apply:

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

ASTM F56	Stainless Steel Sheet and Strip for Surgical Implants.
ASTM F86	Recommended Practice for Surface Requirements of Metallic Surgical Implants.
ASTM B122	Copper-Nickel-Zinc Alloy (Nickel-Silver) and Copper-Nickel Alloy Plate, Sheet, Strip and Rolled Bar.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103).

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The Pharmacopeia of the United States of American (USP)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The suture clips shall be fabricated from unplated, copper alloy number 752 in accordance with ASTM B122. As an alternate, the clips shall be fabricated from annealed, corrosion-resisting steel, conforming to the composition specified in ASTM F56 concerning stainless steel material used for surgical implants, except that the carbon content shall be 0.03 percent maximum.

3.1.1 Grain structure. Grain size of clips fabricated from copper alloy specified above shall be 0.025 millimeters (mm) maximum in accordance with ASTM B122. Grain size of clips fabricated from corrosion-resistant steel specified above shall be size 5 or finer in accordance with ASTM F56.

3.1.2 Hardness. Hardness of copper alloy 752 shall be Rockwell B55 to B75 (76.5 to 85.0 on Rockwell 15-T scale.) Hardness of corrosion-resisting steel specified above shall be Rockwell B75 to B95. All hardness tests shall be as specified in GG-I-526.

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3.2 Finish. The suture clips shall be finished smooth and bright or smooth and satin.

3.3 Style, design and dimensions. The suture clip shall be compressible, of the Michel design, suitable for suturing skin during surgical procedures. Clip shall be of one-piece construction, with two sharp protrusions, one at each formed end and fabricated from material specified in 3.1. General style, design and dimensions of the suture clip shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing 22208.

3.4 Final finishing operation of clip.

3.4.1 Alloy 752 clip. The alloy 752 suture clips shall be washed rigorously and thoroughly in water to remove any residual acid base solutions that may have been used in the manufacturing process of the clips.

3.4.2 Corrosion-resistant steel clip. Corrosion-resistant steel clips shall be properly passivated after completion of all finishing operations. Passivation shall be accomplished by methods described in ASTM F86.

3.5 Performance of clip. The clip shall be capable of being compressed with the two sharp points touching, and also for spring-back (straightening) without breaking or cracking, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

3.6 Resistance to boil test, copper sulfate test and saline test. All suture clips shall show no evidence of pitting or corrosion when subjected to the boil test as specified in 4.4.2.1 and the saline test as specified in 4.4.2.2. In addition to the above, clips fabricated from corrosion-resisting steel specified, shall also be subjected to the copper sulfate test when tested as specified in 4.4.2.3.

3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Clips shall be free from surface roughness, burrs, pits, scale, corrosion and non-uniform appearance.

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4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the copper alloy or stainless steel alloy may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be constructed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table I. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one suture clip.

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Table I. Sampling Criteria for Examination

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	None defined	

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in Table II. The unit of product for testing purposes shall be one suture clip. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Table II. Sampling Criteria for Tests

Component	Characteristic	Reqt	Test procedure	Insp level	AQL
Clip	Grain structure	3.1.1	*ASTM B122 or *ASTM F56	---	---
	Hardness	3.1.2	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
	Dimensions	3.2	---	S-2	1.0
	Performance	3.5	4.4.1	S-2	1.0
	Boil test (all material)	3.6	4.4.2.1	S-2	1.0
	Saline test (all material)	3.6	4.4.2.2	S-2	1.0
	Copper sulfate test (stainless steel)	3.6	4.4.2.3	S-2	1.0

* The unit lot of copper alloy or steel, for which the grain structure is to be determined shall not be larger than one heat.

4.2.3 Raw materials. A sufficient quantity of each lot of each metal used in the construction of the suture clips shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination. The clips shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in Tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in Table III. Any clips in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective clips in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

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Table III. Classification of Defects

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Clip not of the design specified.
102	Clip does not possess sharp extrusions as indicated on drawing (45° reference).
103	Clip not of finish specified.
104	Clip not free from surface roughness, burrs, pits, scale and corrosion.
105	Clip not free from foreign matter.
106	Clip not free from any residual acid base solutions.
107	Clip not thoroughly dried.

4.3.1 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table IV. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Table IV. Examination of Preparation for Delivery

Examine	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Contents	Not as specified.
Markings	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Bulging or distortion of containers. Cushioning inadequate, improper or missing.

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4.3.2 Examination of closure and reinforcement for containers. When shipping containers are required to comply with PPP-B-636, examination for defects in closure and reinforcement shall be in accordance with the appendix of that specification.

4.4 Test Method. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Performance test. The suture clip shall be tested for proper compressibility and spring back by using Suture Clip Forceps constructed in accordance with MIL-F-36053. The clip shall be placed lengthwise between the handle cutout of the forceps, located at the proximal end, with the sharp points facing away from the spring. The forceps shall be closed, utilizing only one hand, with a straight, positive motion. Should the clip properly compress so that the two points touch without the clip breaking or cracking, then the spring-back test shall be performed. The curved or compressed surface of the clip with its sharp points facing down shall be placed between the male and female jaws of the removing end of the forceps, with the cavity of the female jaw facing the operator. The forceps shall then be closed in the same manner described above. The clip shall be observed for clip spring-back, without breaking or cracking.

4.4.2 Corrosion.

4.4.2.1 Boil test. The suture clip shall be subjected to the boil test as described in GG-I-526.

4.4.2.2 Saline test. The suture clip shall be scrubbed with soap and warm water, rinsed in hot water, followed by immersion in ethyl alcohol (95 percent) and dried. Suture clips shall then be completely immersed into Normal Saline Solution (USP) and while immersed, placed into an oven at a temperature of 37 $\pm$ 1 degrees Centigrade for a period of 7 days, removed from the oven and examined for corrosion while still immersed.

4.4.2.3 Copper sulfate test. Suture clips fabricated from corrosion-resistant steel only, shall be subjected to the copper sulfate test as specified in GG-I-526 in addition to the tests specified above.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing four wire holders and each holder containing twenty-five clips, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Four holders, each containing twenty-five clips, shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other anti-corrosive material and packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1. A preservative shall not be applied to clips or holders. As an alternate, the four holders with clips may be packaged in a heat sealed heavy wall plastic bag and tissue wrap may not be applied.

5.1.2.2 Intermediate package. Ten unit packages shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676 except that commercial colors are exceptable. Closure shall be secured to prevent spilling of contents.

5.1.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. One hundred intermediate packages shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in PPP-B-636. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. In addition, each wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed in accordance with paragraph 30.4 and PPP-B-636.

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contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the

NOTE: Strapping shall not be required for shipments forwarded to a receiving activity within the continental limits of the United States for storage and redistribution.

5.2.2 Level B. One hundred intermediate packages shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Fiberboard boxes shall conform to the special requirements as specified in PPP-B-636. Closure of wood boxes shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification. Closure of fiberboard boxes shall conform to method II as specified in PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.3. Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. When labels are utilized, waterproofing shall be required only when applicable carton is fabricated of water-resistant material. Contract or purchase order number and name of contractor shall be shown.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The suture clip, of the Michel design, is used for medical suturing procedures.

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6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) Marking requirements (see 5.3).

6.3 This specification is intended to cover the following item listed in the Federal Supply Catalog:

NSN	Item Identification
6515-00-375-4110	CLIP, SUTURE, MICHEL, 16 mm, 100s

6.4 Supersession data. This specification includes the requirements of Defense Medical Purchase Description No. 2 dated 13 September 1974 for item listed in paragraph 6.3.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-1925
is

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE: GG-C-00439C(DSA-DM)CLIP, SUTURE, MICHAEL, 16

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4 REMARKS

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